

ART & CULTURE



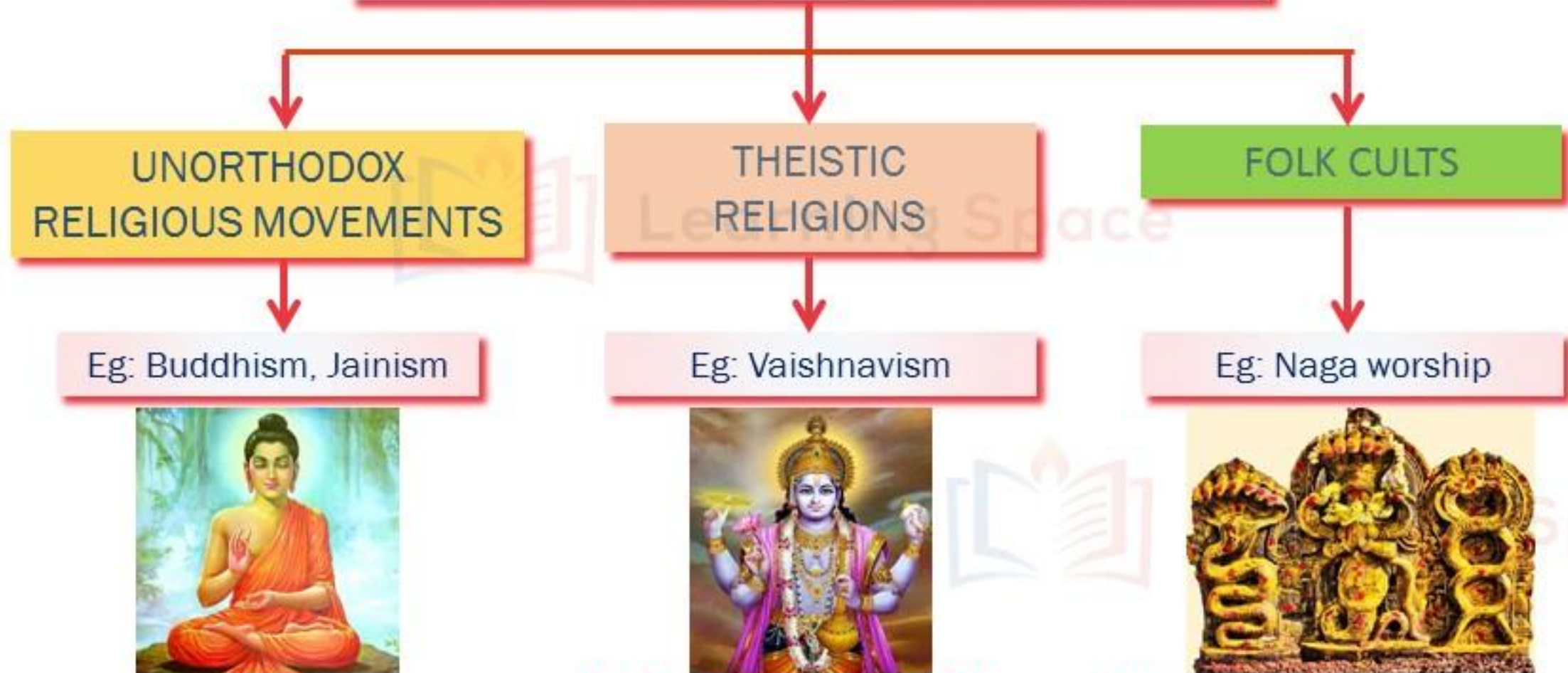
RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

MODULE - 3

- BUDDHISM- INTRODUCTION
- HINDUISM IN THE SOUTH

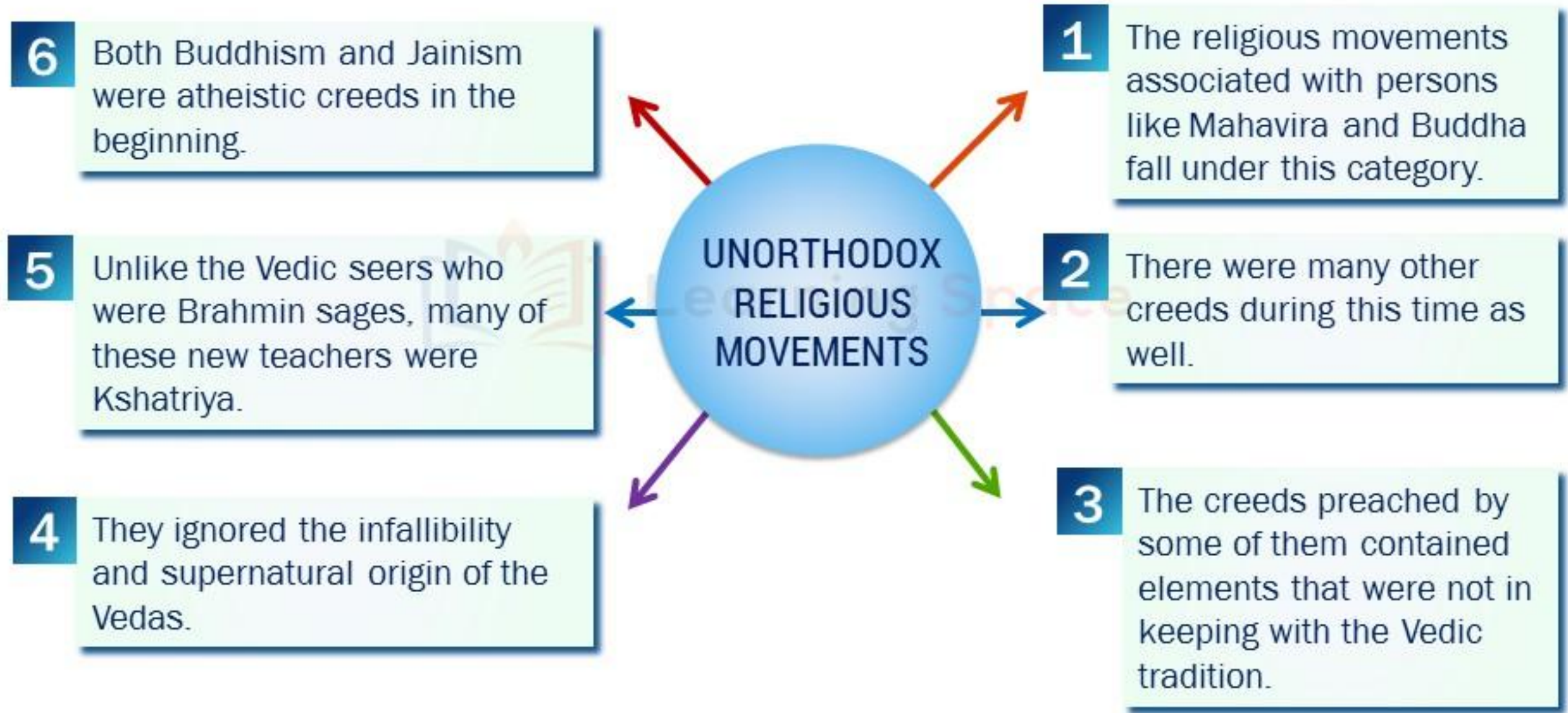
RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

THREE DISTINCTIVE TYPES OF RELIGIOUS MOVEMENTS OBSERVED IN INDIA

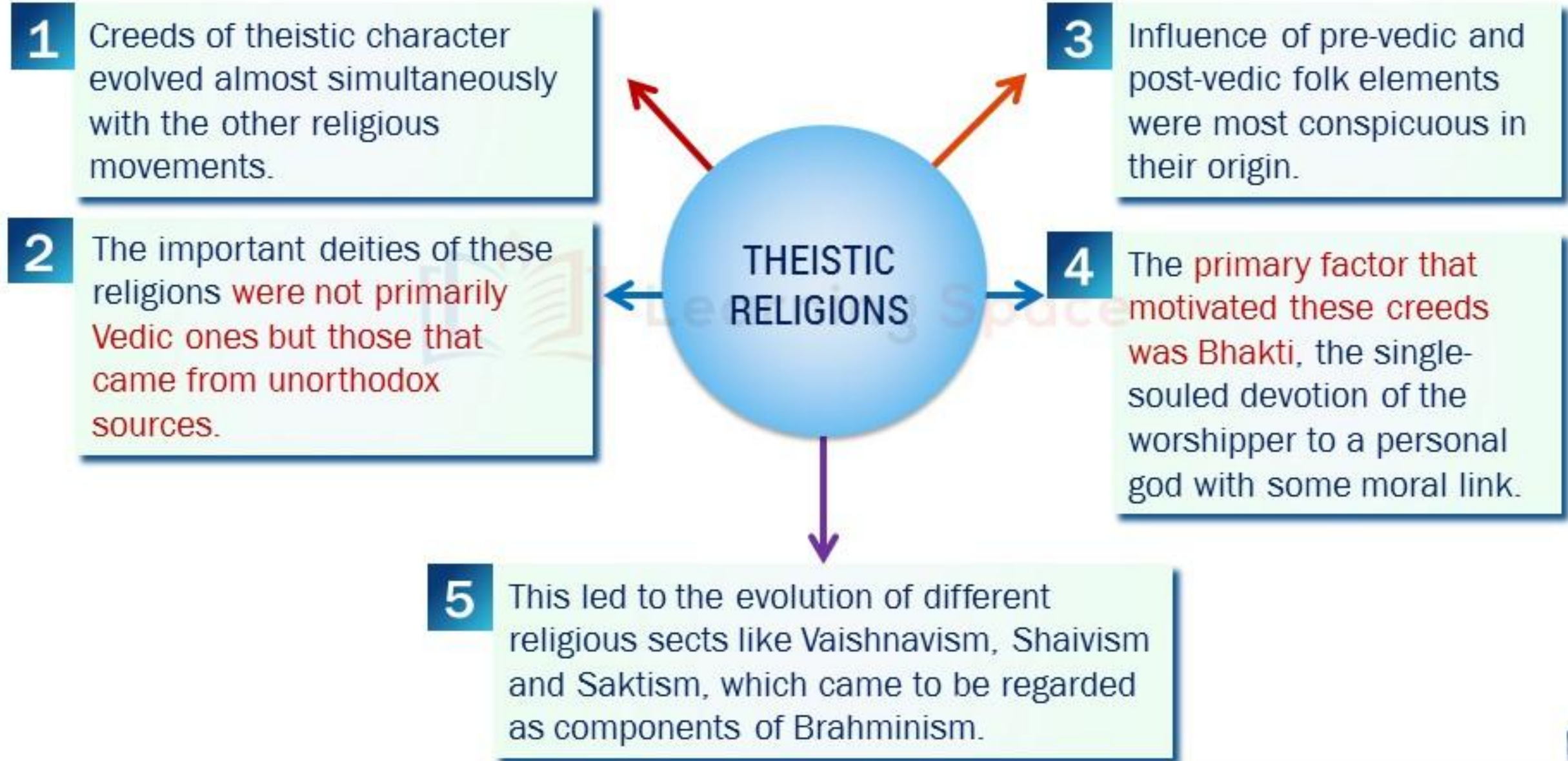


Let us now see a brief description of these religious cults...

RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY



RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY



RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

FOLK CULTS



- 1 The **worship of Yakshas and Nagas** and other folk deities constituted the most important part of primitive religious beliefs, in which Bhakti had a very important role to play.
- 2 There is ample evidence about the prevalence of this form of worship among the people in early literature as well as in archaeology.

RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

VASUDEVA/KRISHNA WORSHIP



- 5 From the late Gupta period the name mostly used to designate this Bhakti cult was **Vaishnava**.

- 1 A Sutra in Panini's Ashtadhyayi refers to the worshippers of Vasudeva.
- 2 The Chhandogya Upanishad also speaks of Krishna, the son of Devaki.
- 3 A large number of people worshipped Vasudeva Krishna exclusively as their personal God and they were at first known as **Bhagavatas**.
- 4 The Vasudeva-Bhagavata cult grew steadily, absorbing within its fold other Brahminic divinities like **Vishnu** (primarily an aspect of the sun) and **Narayana** (a cosmic God).

RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

VASUDEVA/KRISHNA WORSHIP IN SOUTH INDIA



*Andal is the only female saint-poet
amongst the Alvars.*

- 1 The history of the Vaishnava movement from the end of the Gupta period till the first decade of the thirteenth century AD is concerned mainly with South India.
- 2 Vaishnava poet-saints known as **alvars** (a Tamil word denoting those drowned in Vishnu-bhakti) preached single-minded devotion (ekatmika bhakti) for Vishnu and their songs were collectively known as **divya prabandhas**.



RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

SHIVA WORSHIP



- 1 The Shaiva movement in the South flourished at the beginning through the activities of many of the 63 saints known in Tamil as **Nayanars (Siva-bhakts)**.
- 2 Their appealing emotional songs in Tamil were called **Tevaram Stotras**, also known as Dravida Veda and ceremonially sung in the local Shiva temples.
- 3 The Nayanars hailed from all castes.

RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

MINOR RELIGIOUS MOVEMENTS

- 1 Worship of the female principle (Shakti) and of Surya did not achieve equal importance as much as the other 2 major brahminical cults.
- 2 The female aspect of the divinity might have been venerated in the pre-Vedic times.
- 3 In the Vedic age respect was shown also to the female principle as the **Divine Mother, the Goddess of abundance and personified energy (Shakti)**.
- 4 However, clear reference to the exclusive worshippers of the Devi is not to be found **until a comparatively late period**.
- 5 As mentioned earlier, Surya has been venerated in India from the earliest times.
- 6 In Vedic and epic mythology, Sun and his various aspects played a very important part.
- 7 The East Iranian (Shakadvipi) form of the **solar cult** was introduced in parts of northern India in the early centuries of the Christian era.

CONTENTS OF BUDDHISM LECTURES

- ✓ Buddhism- An Introduction
- ✓ Buddhism- A Brief History
- ✓ Spread of Buddhism- Buddhist Councils
- ✓ Teachings & Philosophy of Buddha
- ✓ Buddhist Scriptures
- ✓ Important Bodhisattvas
- ✓ Places associated with the life of Buddha
- ✓ Sects in Buddhism
- ✓ Event & Symbols in Buddhism
- ✓ Mudras of Buddha
- ✓ Causes for the decline

BUDDHISM- AN INTRODUCTION



1 Buddhism is the 4th largest religion in the world having nearly 500-550 million followers (7%-8% of the world population).

2 It is concentrated largely in Asia with the maximum Buddhist presence in China and other countries in Southeast Asia (viz. Cambodia, Myanmar, and Thailand), South Asia (Sri Lanka), and East Asia (Japan).

3 Buddhism as a religion was founded by Gautama Buddha in the 6th century BCE in India.

4 It has a history of more than 2500 years, making it one of the oldest living religions in the world along with Hinduism, Judaism etc.

BUDDHISM- AN INTRODUCTION



- 5 It is divided into **numerous sects**, viz. Mahayana, Hinayana, Vajrayana and Theravada.
- 6 It has a rich philosophy, captured in the Tripitakas and other **Buddhist scriptures**.
- 7 These texts also throw light on the history of the religion and the regions indicating the profound impact on art, culture, and other social aspects of the countries where Buddhism had flourished.

BUDDHISM

A BRIEF HISTORY

ORIGIN OF BUDDHISM



Fa Hien



Hiuen Tsang

- 1 The history of Buddhism falls under the category of **recorded history** (unlike early Hinduism).

- 2 Events and occurrences have been found to be recorded in the various **Buddhist texts and accounts of travelers and writers like Faxian and Xuanzang.**

- 3 Further, inscriptions and edicts of emperor Ashoka and other kings which survive to this day on stupas, chaityas, and other rock inscriptions, serve as an important source of information about Buddhism.

BUDDHISM

A BRIEF HISTORY

ORIGIN OF BUDDHISM

4 As per the accepted historical account, Buddhism originated in the teachings of Buddha (also referred as Gautama, Siddhartha, Sakyamuni).

5 He was born in 563 BCE to king **Suddhodhana** (a Sakya ruler of Kapilvastu) and **Maya Devi**, in **Lumbini** (in present day Nepal).

6 It is said that owing to **predictions of seers**, that he would either become a great emperor or a great sage, his father restricted his life to the comforts of the palace.

7 He was married to **Yashodhara** and had a son **Rahul**.

8 Once, in a venture outside the palace, the sight of a sick man, an old man, a corpse, and a monk (referred to as the 'four sights') deeply influenced him.

BUDDHISM

A BRIEF HISTORY

ORIGIN OF BUDDHISM



9 He **renounced** his worldly life, family, and kingdom in pursuit of the truth (“**Mahabhinishkramana**”).

10 After many years of asceticism and mediation, Buddha attained enlightenment in Bodh Gaya under a **Pipal tree (called the Bodhi tree)** and hence became Buddha – one who is enlightened.

BUDDHISM

A BRIEF HISTORY

ORIGIN OF BUDDHISM

- 11** He delivered his **first sermon** to his five disciples at **Sarnath** (Varanasi), an event called the **Dharmachakra Pravartana** or the turning of the Wheel Of Law.



- 12** This marks a **formal beginning** of the **Buddhist religion**.
- 13** This was also the beginning of the **Sangha** (the order of monks).
- 14** Buddha spent the rest of his life in preaching in different parts of the country – **largely in Magadh and Kosala Mahajanpads**.
- 15** He attained **Mahaparinirvana** at **Kusinagra** (in present day Uttar Pradesh).

QUICK SUMMARY OF FACTS ABOUT BUDDHISM

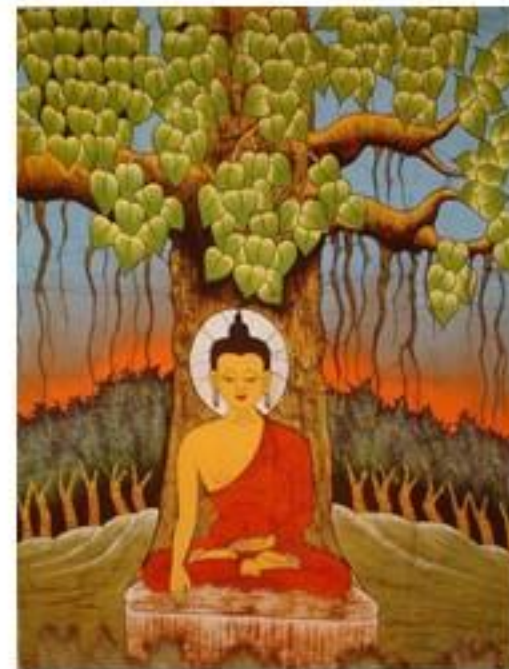
OTHER NAME	SIDDHARTHA
FATHER	SHUDDODHANA
MOTHER	MAHAMAYA
REPUBLIC	SHAKYA CLAN
CAPITAL	KAPILVASTU
RAISED BY	GAUTAMI
WIFE	YASHODHARA
SON	RAHUL
BORN	LUMBINI (NEPAL)
YEAR	563 BC TO 483 BC

EVENTS AND SYMBOLS IN BUDDHISM

- 1** **LOTUS:** This represents purity and the birth of Buddha.



- 2** **PIPAL/BODHI TREE:** It represents attainment of enlightenment by Buddha.



EVENTS AND SYMBOLS IN BUDDHISM

3 WHEEL:

- This represents the delivering of the first sermon by Buddha at Sarnath or Dharmachakra Pravartana.
- The 8 spokes of the wheel represent the eightfold path of Buddhism.



4 STUPA:

This represents the Mahaparinirvana of Buddha.



EVENTS AND SYMBOLS IN BUDDHISM

5 EMPTY THRONE:

This represents the Buddha himself and it is also a reference to his **royal ancestry**. At times it also signifies the **Buddha in meditation**.



6 LION:

This symbol traditionally represents **strength, power and royalty** and it is also **representative of Buddha**.



EVENTS AND SYMBOLS IN BUDDHISM

7 FOOTPRINTS:

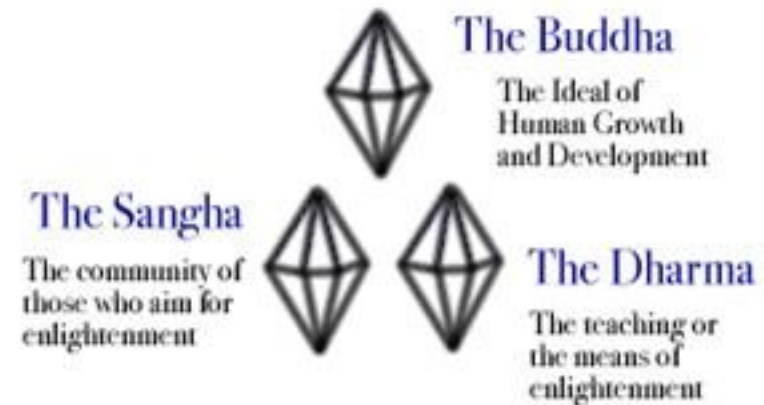
It is representative of the footprints of the Buddha and his presence.



8 THREE JEWELS (TRIRATNA):

The triple gems represent the **Buddha**, the **Dhamma**, and the **Sangha**.

The Three Jewels - The Triratna



EVENTS AND SYMBOLS IN BUDDHISM

9

DEER:

- Deer symbols usually includes two parts that are “deer” and “the dharma wheel”
- It is a reference to Buddha’s first teaching at Deer Park in Sarnath.



10

ELEPHANT:

It represents valour, strength and wisdom.



BUDDHISM

SPREAD OF BUDDHISM

- 1 Buddhism soon spread in India and different parts of South Asia and Southeast Asia.
- 2 The factors existing in the Indian society, viz. – **excessive emphasis on ritualism, Brahmanical superiority, and caste system on one hand and simple teachings of Buddhism with emphasis on ahimsa, equality, compassion, etc. on the other hand** endeared it to the masses.
- 3 Further, patronage and propagation by several emperors and kings also enabled it to spread far and wide.
- 4 Emperor **Ashoka** and his missions to Sri Lanka, Southeast Asia, China, patronage of Buddhism by **Menander-I**, by the **Kushanas** particularly emperor Kanishka, by **Pala** Kings, and by Emperor **Harsha**, were important factors for its spread far and wide.
- 5 However, with the decline of royal patronage beyond the reign of Harsha and with **rejuvenation and consolidation of Hinduism as a result of efforts of Shankaracharya and other Hindu religious leaders**, Buddhism suffered a decline in India, although it continued to spread in other countries.

BUDDHISM

COUNCIL	TIME	PATRONAGE	MONK	WHERE	MOTIVE	FACTS
1st BUDDHIST COUNCIL	400 BC	King Ajatshatru	Mahakasyapa	Rajgriha	To preserve Buddha's teachings (Sutta) and rules for disciples (Vinaya)	- Ananda, great disciple recited Sutta - Upali, another disciple recited Vinaya
2nd BUDDHIST COUNCIL	383 BC	King Kalasoka	Sabakami	Vaishali	To settle a dispute on Vinaya Pitaka, the code of discipline	
3rd BUDDHIST COUNCIL	250 BC	King Ashoka	Moggaliputta Tissa	Pataliputra	Abhidhamma Pitaka was established and now known as "Tripitaka"	
4th BUDDHIST COUNCIL	72 AD	Kushan King Kanishka	Vasumitra with Asvagosha as his deputy	Kundalvana Kashmir	Divided Buddhism into 2 sects Mahayan & Hinayan.	

WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

OUR TEAM

G. V. Rao

K. Srikanth

D. Sunil Kumar

L. V. Krishna

Y. Deepthi

Amrita Naidu

M. Binukrishna

G. Ravi Babu

D. Joji

K. Victor Babu

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0 8 6 6 -2 4 4 4 4 7 2

0 9 8 4 9 9 4 2 2 9 9